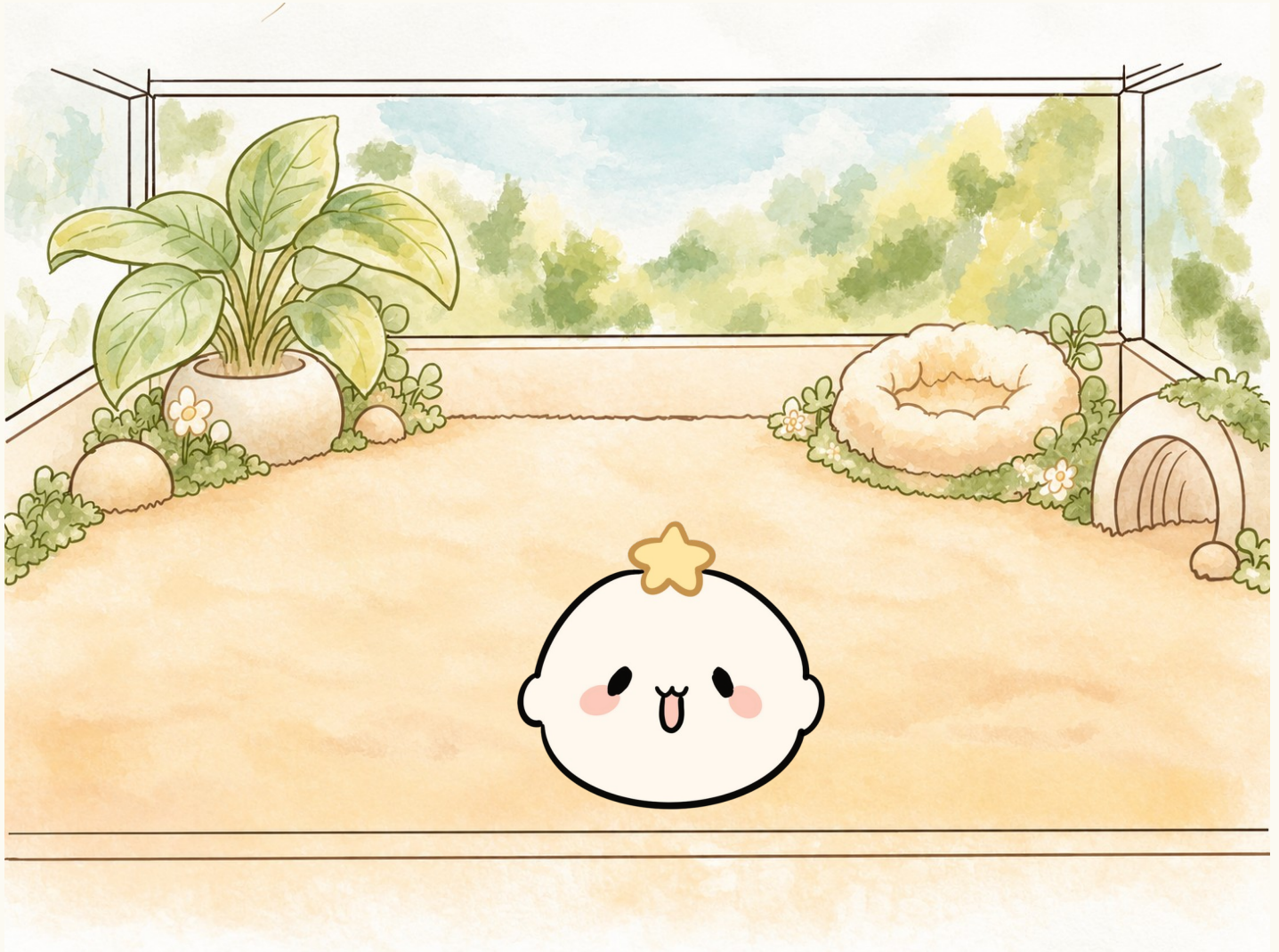
Little Rascal

Name a pet.

Care for it as it grows.

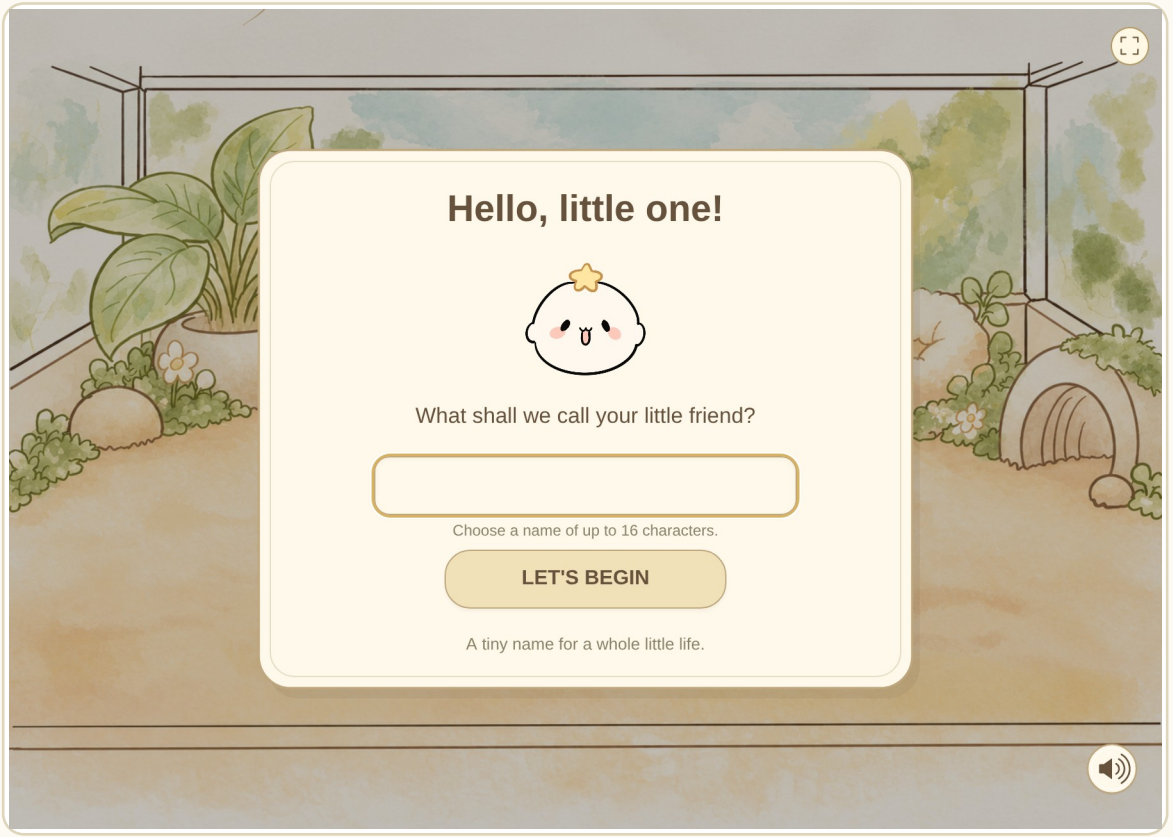


A virtual pet game made with p5.js

Giving it a name

“This is my pet.”

A name helps the player feel connected to the pet and responsible for its care.



A rocking egg invites the first click. Naming follows the shooting-star arrival.

How the game works

00:00–00:25

Egg, arrival and naming

00:25–00:55

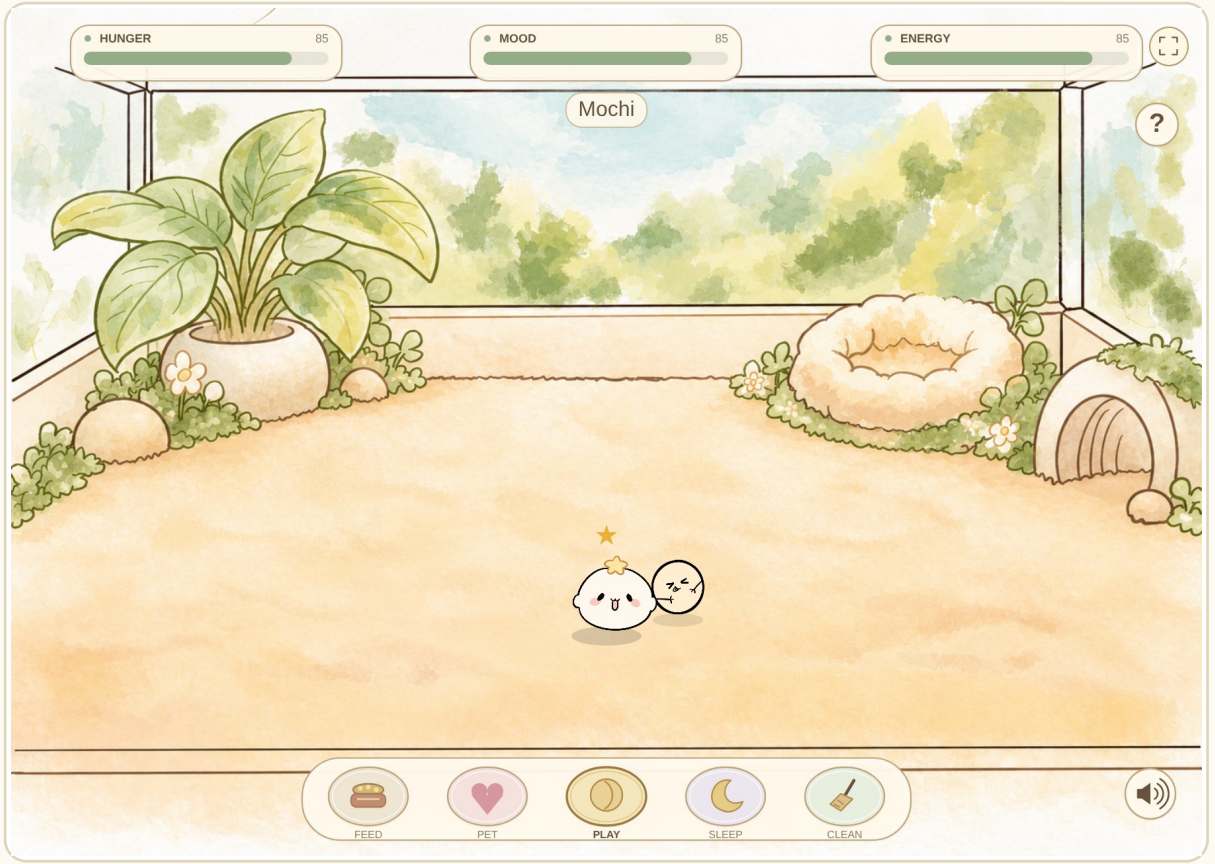
Feed, pet and throw the toy

00:55–01:20

Youth reactions

01:20–02:00

Old age, letter and new egg



Recording plan: insert a two-minute gameplay edit. Use clear cuts between stages.

What I wanted the player to feel

VISCERAL

First impression

Soft room and
approachable character.

BEHAVIOURAL

During play

Feed, pet or throw.
See and hear a response.

REFLECTIVE

What it means

My pet, my care,
and a life I watched grow.

Norman (2004). Examples describe the intended experience.

Three stages, three different responses

FOUR STAGES → THREE: A SHORTER EXPERIENCE



LITTLE ONE

Needs food, affection and rest.



YOUTH

Mischievous; sometimes refuses care.



SENIOR

Slower; actively asks for affection.

Little One: 3 useful feeds or pettings TOTAL → sleep → wake as Youth.

Making the toy something to play with

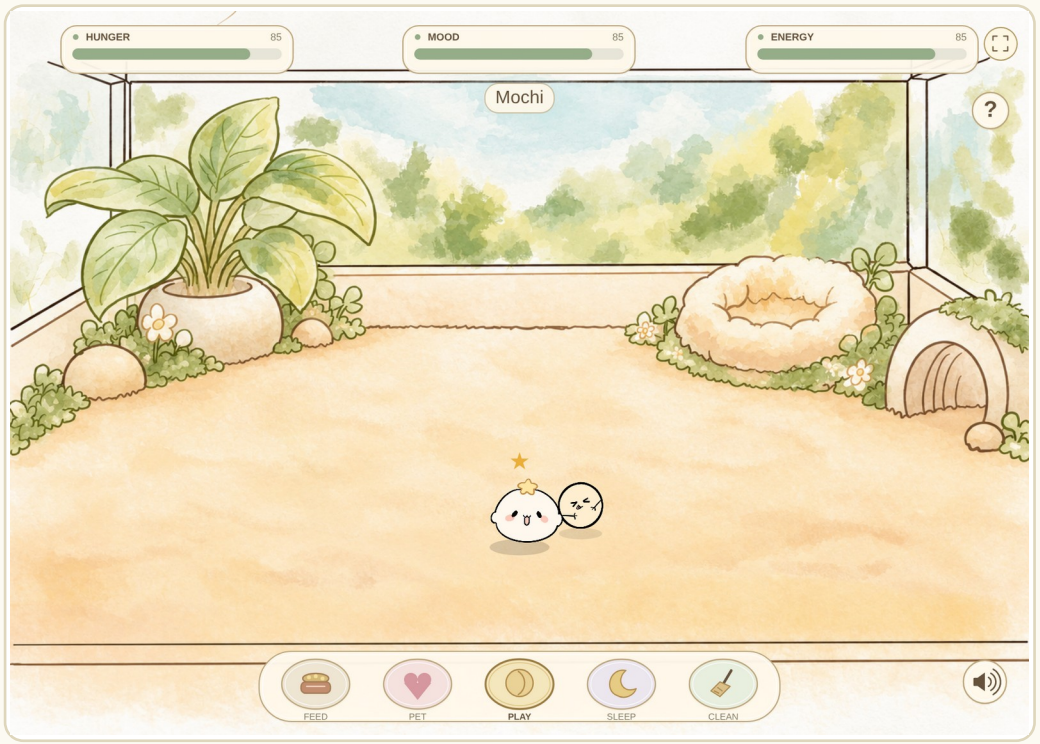
BEFORE

Playing through a button.

Chasing looked disconnected.

The pet moved too fast.

AFTER



Pick up → throw → approach → touch → small kick

A short recorded call plays when the pet makes the friendly contact kick.

Youth has a temper



HAPPY

Accepts the interaction.



UNIMPRESSED

Repetition or a full need.

Stays still.



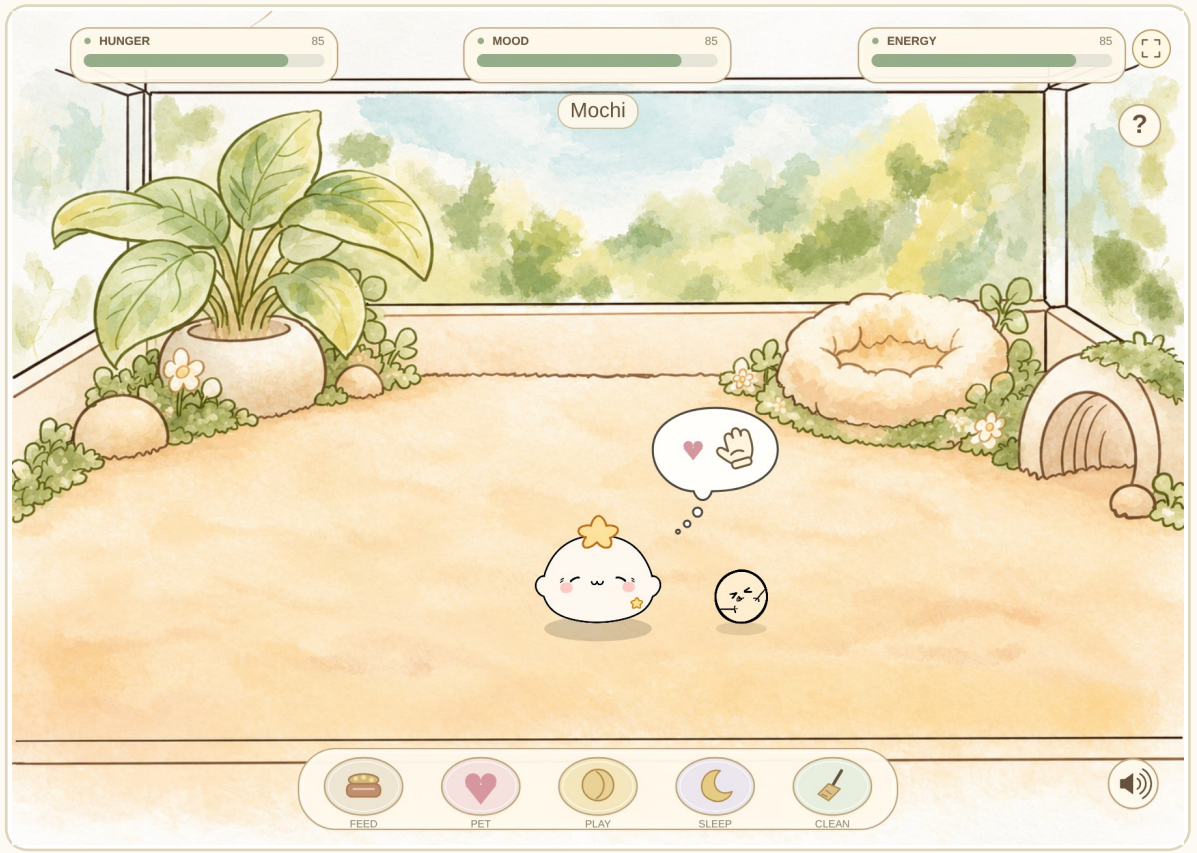
ANGRY

May jump away

or kick the toy away.

25% baseline angry refusal. The player needs to notice and respond to the pet’s reaction.

Older and more attached to the player



MORE ATTACHED

Actively asks
to be petted.

SLOWER MOVEMENT

Three small, slow hops.
Then ~3 seconds of rest.

Earlier versions looked like slow motion or grounded walking. Hopping and rest kept the pet's character.

Showing how the pet feels



HUNGER BELOW 30

The body shows it needs food.

RECORDED VOICE

Petting · anger · crying

Kicking · idle humming

Face + body + voice

help the player notice its needs.

Tutor feedback: clearer needs and more sound. Crying plays once on entry; the speaker controls BGM only.

Why the pet can die

RESPONSIBILITY

Care affects survival.

The player needs to keep paying attention.

CHALLENGE

Food, mood and cleaning

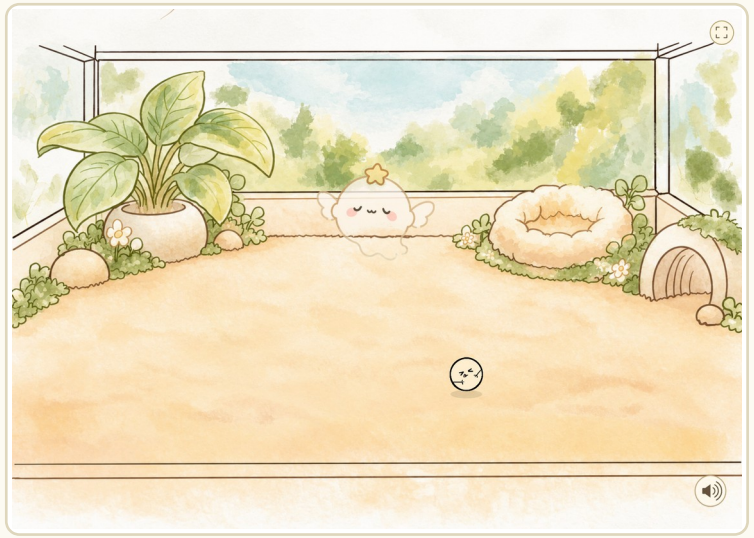
all have consequences.

Neglect can lead to death.

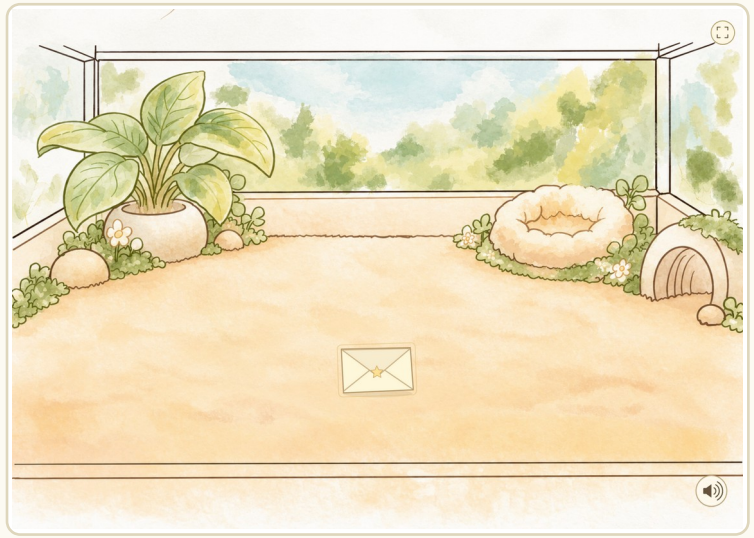
Natural old age has a separate farewell.

Only natural old age leads to the thank-you letter.

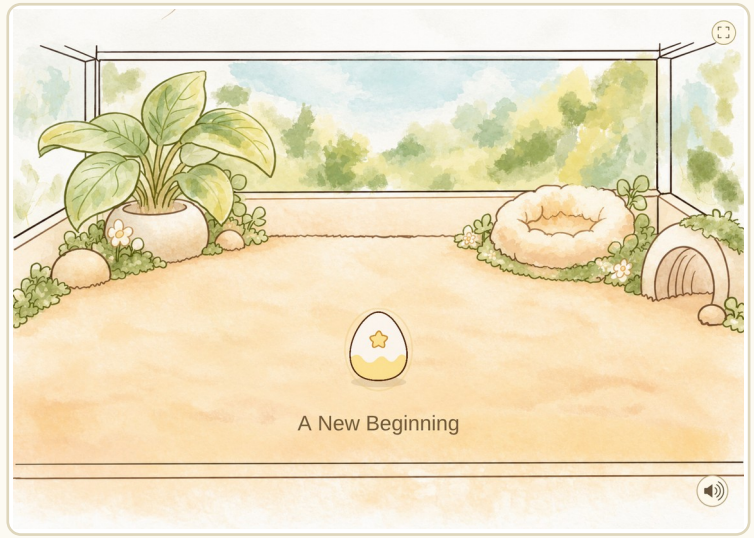
Goodbye, then a new egg



The pet dissolves into stars



The player opens the letter



Starlight forms a new egg

Birth → growth → death → new life

The letter waits for a click. Closing it begins the return to a new egg.

What feedback changed

CLASSMATES Music, expressions and toy play	Background music; hungry pose; a toy the player can pick up and throw.
TUTOR Sound and visible needs	Recorded calls; retain the hungry pose alongside the need bars.
MY PLAYTHROUGHS Movement and pacing	Contact kick; senior hop/rest; a longer arrival before naming.

What works, and what I would improve

WHAT WORKS

Care changes across stages.

The older pet actively seeks company.

WHAT I WOULD IMPROVE

Make the toy easier to discover.

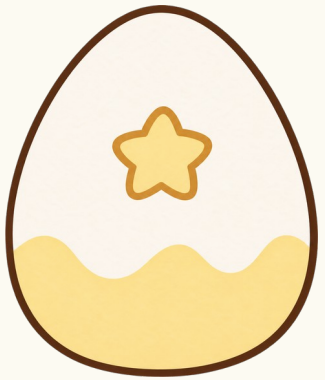
Check that warnings are clear in time.

Observe first-time players in the shortened three-stage experience.

Next step: improve cues while keeping the intended responsibility and challenge.

From one egg to the next

Name. Care. Grow.
Say goodbye. Begin again.

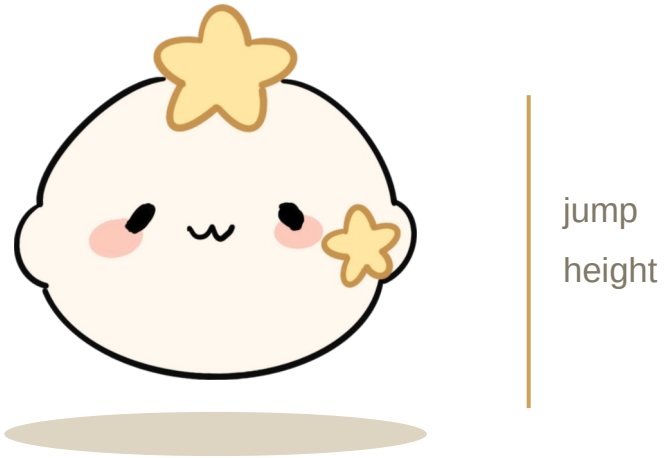


A connection to your pet.
Responsibility for its life.

PLAY LITTLE RASCAL ↗️

How the movement works

Ground position + jump height



DRAWING

2D images, layered by floor position.

MOVEMENT

Separate airborne height; shadow on the floor.

TOY CONTACT

Collision checks trigger the kick and its sound.

Supporting diagram; no extra narration. Internal canvas stays at 900 × 640.

References & source notes

FRAMEWORK	Norman, D. A. (2004). Emotional design: Why we love (or hate) everyday things. Basic Books.
TECHNICAL LIBRARY	Processing Foundation. (n.d.). p5.js reference. https://p5js.org/reference/
ASSESSMENT	Curtin University. (n.d.). GRDE2040 Assignment Two: Emotional Interactions [brief]; A2 Playful Exhibition [rubric]. User-supplied course documents.
PLAY REFERENCE	My Lil' Bastard — user-supplied gameplay video/screenshots. Publisher, year and exact source require confirmation.
PROJECT SOURCE	Little Rascal. Source: https://github.com/itsangelia/little-rascal Gameplay baseline: 387cfd0. Images show current staged game states, not audience footage.
MEDIA CREDITS	User-uploaded illustrations and AI-assisted visual iterations. BGM: Pixabay (designer-reported; track / artist / URL to add). Pet voice: recorded by the designer, then excerpted for the game.

Author–date draft: check the exact reference style required by the unit outline.

AI assistance & submission record

DRAFT DISCLOSURE · AUTHOR MUST VERIFY

OpenAI ChatGPT/Codex assisted with ideation, visual explorations, coding, debugging, audio excerpt processing, and editing slides and narration.

The designer confirms tutor approval for AI assistance. The record documents their selections, rejected options and repeated revisions. Personal analysis must be checked and expressed in their own words.

Submission checks	AI scope declaration · music track credit · feedback given to a peer Curtin cover sheet · video link + timestamp · source link · required filename

AI permission and voice authorship are designer-reported; no formal audience study is claimed.